Subtracting Fractions

To subtract like fractions, just subtract the numerators. The denominator remains the same.

$$\frac{3}{8} - \frac{1}{8} = \frac{2}{8} = \frac{1}{4}$$

The answer to an addition or subtraction problem may need to be simplified. Always write your answers in lowest terms. Change improper fractions to mixed numbers.

Example

Hide

$$\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{4}$$

Step 1

Subtract the numerators.

$$\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{4} \leftarrow 3 - 1 = 2$$

Step 2

Place the result over the denominator.

$$\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{4} = \frac{2}{4} \leftarrow 3 - 1 = 2$$

Step 3

Simplify if necessary.

$$\frac{3}{4} - \frac{1}{4} = \frac{2}{4} \div \frac{2}{2} = \frac{1}{2}$$

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Lesson 5: Operations with Fractions

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